

Orisys Opts for Open Source

OrisysIndia, a Kerala-based IT solutions provider, is using open source to deliver advanced communication solutions to call centres in Kerala at a mere 10 per cent of the cost of similar proprietary solutions.



Team OrisysIndia with Mervin Alexander, CEO, Technopark (standing fifth from left)

OrisysIndia is an incubatee firm at Trivandrum's Technopark, and is into providing IT consultancy and solutions related to domains such as Web applications, website design and development, e-commerce services, telephony solutions, and many others. You may well wonder what's new about it since there is no dearth of IT consultants and solutions providers in the market.

What makes Orisys an interesting case to evaluate is the fact that the company has been able to create a niche for itself by developing a sophisticated yet drastically low-cost communications solution for call centres, by leveraging Asterisk, a free and open source software that transforms a computer into a communications server.

A telephony solution with a difference

Arun Raj, CEO, OrisysIndia, shares more details about the Asterisk telephony solution, which he believes is revolutionary in many ways: "One of our clients (name kept anonymous on request) is running a call centre with 10 telecallers. The firm was using a typical PBX box and commonly-used analogue phones. The traffic mainly related to outbound calls, with an average of 60 to 65 calls per user, per day.

"This proved very cumbersome, as it included a process of dialling numbers and then manually posting call feedback entries and sorting data. Replacing this, we have now

implemented a CRM-integrated Asterisk-based customer care solution. Asterisk provides a complete set of tools that can be used to route calls, set up a conference bridge, VoIP gateway, IVR system, etc. It is one of the most powerful platforms, which offers full voice call control to programmers.

"If you use conventional PBX hardware like what is provided by vendors like Cisco and Avaya, it costs approximately Rs 20-30 lakh. But our solution costs around Rs 2-5 lakh, depending upon the nature of the complete solution required by a customer, which may involve CRM integration, developing the IVR tree, solution customisation, and so on. I think this solution has the potential to trigger a revolution in the telecom industry."

In the new system, calls are initiated from the computer itself at a single mouse click. "The productivity of agents has increased to 125 to 135 calls per day, which is double their earlier daily average. The process of data sorting and reports generation, too, has been automated," he adds.

Apart from developing Asterisk-based telephony solutions, the company works extensively on a number of open technology platforms, frameworks and libraries such as PHP, CodeIgniter, Symfony, Zend, MySQL, Drupal, Magento Wordpress, Joomla, jQuery, and so on, to suit the other specific needs of its clients.